The CEO Checklist

If you are about to sign - stop and ask these questions

Use this page when an SAP order form, RISE agreement, add-on, AI subscription or SI statement of work is on the table. Every question must be answered with a document or a number - not a slide.

	#	Question to answer before signing
□	1	What exact business problem are we solving, and who in the business signed the requirement?
□	2	What does standard SAP already provide in our release, and what do we already own?
□	3	What exact licence, metric, quantity and term are we committing to - and which clause lets us reduce or convert it?
□	4	What happens to this commitment if automation removes 25% of transactional user activity during the term?
□	5	What will our AI consumption cost per year, at what fixed rate, with what cap?
□	6	Which responsibilities stay with us under this contract, according to the Roles and Responsibilities document?
□	7	Is our master data - materials, suppliers, equipment, hierarchy - ready for what this investment assumes?
□	8	What is the five-year and seven-year TCO, compared on the same basis with the alternatives?
□	9	Where will our data live, who can access it, can it train vendor models, and how do we get it back?
□	10	How do we exit, what does it cost, and who has independently challenged the SI's scope and estimate?

Value protection conditions - evidenced before signature

	Condition	Evidence
□	Requirement validated	Signed business requirement
□	Standard capability mapped	Fit-gap with SAP references
□	Existing licence mapped	Entitlement and usage report
□	Duplicate capability checked	Capability map across owned products
□	Product overlap checked	Overlap analysis
□	Architecture validated	Architecture decision record
□	Data readiness assessed	Data maturity assessment
□	AI readiness assessed	Use-case pilot results and controls
□	Integration cost assessed	Interface inventory and cost
□	Customisation cost assessed	Custom code estimate and clean core level
□	BTP cost assessed	Consumption forecast
□	AI Unit cost assessed	Rate, forecast, cap, expiry
□	SI effort challenged	Independent estimate review
□	Five-year TCO calculated	TCO model
□	Seven-year TCO calculated	TCO model incl. renewal and upgrade
□	Exit strategy defined	Exit plan and contract clauses
□	Governance approved	Steering committee minute

JM ETA ADVISORY PRINCIPLE

PROVE THE NEED. PROVE THE STANDARD. PROVE THE LICENCE. PROVE THE ARCHITECTURE. PROVE THE VALUE. THEN SPEND.